

Life in the iLane

Except for the iPod—just except for that one piece of hardware—Apple is niche. Niche, niche, niche—so much so, you’re probably wondering why we bothered to bring out this book. Who needs a Mac anyway?

Simple answer. We thought we’d educate you that little bit, so you get out of the mindset that there’s no need to even think Apple. We aren’t aiming at making converts out of any of you. We aren’t taking a stance. We aren’t saying Apple is great (or that it’s not). We just want to speak a little about what’s in that third computing camp.

History is sometimes interesting, and we start off with some about Apple—including, yes, why and when it became niche. (You can’t think Apple without thinking “niche.”) We talk a bit about the iPod—its variants and what exactly is so damn cool about it. Then of course there’s the iPhone: why so much buzz? You’ll find out exactly why there is so much buzz.

Then, coming to Apple computers, we first talk about Apple’s range of Desktops and laptops—an introduction that, we hope, will increase your awareness of what’s what in that space. Chapter 5 talks about OS X, what’s so cool about it, and since we aren’t biased, we also tell you what’s not cool about it. Chapter 6, then, is a “switcher’s guide”—if you get a new Apple computer, here’s how you move everything over from your Windows computer to your pretty new Mac. (Yes, they *are* pretty.)

Under software, you’ll find chapters on the iLife suite, which comes bundled with Macintosh computers. We then speak about essential software for a new Mac: yes, there most certainly isn’t as much out there for Macs as for Windows, but you get what you need.

Whether you have a Mac, or whether you don’t, whether you bought one after reading this, or whether you didn’t, we think you should know something about Apple and their line-up. We hope this book serves that purpose.